

celebrating the life of
Willie Lee Grider



November 5, 1933 ~ September 11, 2026

In Loving Memory of Willie Lee (Chambers) Grider

*A Virtuous Woman - Proverbs 31:10-31
November 5, 1933 - September 11, 2026*

Willie Lee (Chambers) Grider was born on November 5, 1933, in Washington, Arkansas, to the late Richard Chambers, Jr. and Birdie (Conway) Chambers. She was the sixth of eight children, which included one boy and seven girls. The Chambers family remained in Washington, Arkansas until they moved to Hot Springs, Arkansas in 1945. Willie shared fond memories of her Father and Brother playing their harmonicas in front of the family while she and all of her siblings still lived at home; quality family time that she truly cherished.

Willie attended Elementary School in Washington, Arkansas and Desarc, Arkansas and Langston Jr/Sr High school in Hot Springs, Arkansas. At that time Langston was the only School for blacks in Hot Springs so it was a combined Jr/Sr High School.

Willie's parents instilled within their children the importance of a relationship with Christ. Members of the Church of Christ, her parents rotated hosting church services and bible classes in their home until the members (her Father included) were able to build a permanent meeting place, the Silver Street Church of Christ in Hot Springs. At the age of 15 years old, Willie decided that she wanted to be baptized but there was one problem, the Silver Street Church of Christ did not have a baptismal pool. Willie did not allow that hurdle stop her. Although the South was still heavily segregated, a local congregation with all-White members allowed her to be baptized at their building. Praise God!

In early 1953 Willie met J.D. Grider and the two were united in marriage on December 23, 1953. Their union included the added blessing of a blended family with 12 children! Seeking more opportunities, Willie and J.D. relocated to Richmond, California in November 1964. Upon their arrival she placed her membership at the Southside Church of Christ in Richmond under the leadership of Minister Frances F. Carson and later Minister Jack Wooling.

Willie and J.D.'s marriage was full of love and commitment to one another. In 1984 J.D. was diagnosed with Alzheimer's disease and by 1986, he was completely bedridden. Willie's dedication to her marriage became increasingly evident as she put her life on hold to become her husband's full-time caregiver. Willie lovingly took care of her husband until his death on September 13, 1994.

A woman of perseverance and dedication, she worked throughout her life as a Housekeeper, Seamstress in a shoe factory, and as a Teacher's Aide. In each role, she served others with care and a strong work ethic.

A gifted homemaker, Willie Lee enjoyed sewing, cooking, baking, and quilting. One of her most cherished traditions was baking Christmas cookies for family and friends, filling their homes and hearts with warmth and joy. Her favorite flower was the calla lily, a fitting symbol of the grace and beauty with which she lived.

Willie was a devoted Christian whose faith guided her life. Her favorite scripture was Isaiah 40:31, which reads: "But they that wait upon the Lord shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint."

During her membership at the Southside Church of Christ, she was a member of the Sick & Shut-In Committee, where she visited ailing members at hospitals, facilities and residences. She also volunteered monthly at both the church's Food Giveaways and at the local Super Kitchen. In addition, she was a regular participant of Southside's monthly Sister's Class and yearly Thanksgiving Basket and Sweet Potato Pie Baking events, providing holiday meals for the less fortunate.

In 2006, Willie relocated to Sacramento, California and placed her membership at the Parkway Church of Christ under the leadership of Minister Poncho Hobbes and later Minister Stanley Winter Sr. Up until her passing she was a member of the Kentucky Avenue Church of Christ in Woodland, California. In her latter years her health began to slowly decline, however she continued to prioritize attending weekly church services, Bible classes and church events as well as to contribute towards worthy causes.

Willie deeply loved her family and especially treasured time spent with her children, grandchildren, great-grandchildren, and great-great-grandchildren. A recent revelation was her joy of people-watching, especially her family members. She was often heard telling others with a smile "I have kids, grandkids, great-grandkids, and great-great-grandkids!"

Willie Lee Grider entered eternal rest peacefully at her home in Sacramento California on Friday September 11, 2026. She was blessed with 92 years of life and was surrounded by family and close friends during her peaceful transition: all true testaments of God's enduring love, grace and mercy towards the righteous. Although she will be deeply missed by friends and family, she will never be forgotten.

Willie Lee was preceded in death by her parents Richard and Birdie Chambers, her husband J.D. Grider, her sons, Ronnie Lee Thompson, Sr., Eddie Pete Grider, Jerry Grider, her daughter Ophelia "Sister" Alexander, her brother Joe Henry Chambers, and her sisters Jenny Chambers, Verlie Roddy, Lillian Durham, Cora Durham, Ira Pearl Chambers and her grandson John "Pumpkin" Hastings, Jr.

Willie Lee leaves to cherish her memory her sister, Margie Reed of Hot Springs, Arkansas; her daughters, Marilyn Quilter, Sherron Grider, Joyce Grider, Cynthia Fields (Richard), Olivia Tucker (Windle), Elsie Cobbs (Grover), daughter-in-law, Sylvia "Vicky" Thompson; and her sons, Terence Grider (Sherry) and Thomas Grider.

She also leaves a host of grandchildren, great-grandchildren, great-great-grandchildren, nieces, nephews, cousins, close family friends, church family and all whose lives were blessed by her love.

Willie Lee will be remembered for her steadfast faith, devotion to family, generous spirit, strength, meekness, kindness, and the many loving traditions she created.

"Well done, good and faithful servant... Enter into the joy of your Lord."
- **Matthew 25:23**

Order of Services

Processional

Clergy, Family and Pallbearers

Welcome

*Quinn Reddrick Sr.
Master of Ceremonies*

Opening Prayer

Earnest Madison

Congregational Song

*Corey Williams
"If We Never Meet Again"*

Scripture Reading

*Richard Fields Sr.
Old Testament ~ Isaiah 40:31
New Testament ~ 2 Timothy 4:7*

Congressional Song

*Corey Williams
"It Won't Be Very Long"*

Special Remarks

*Damon Hastings
"Memories"*

Obituary Reading

Teyana Ybarra

Video

Words of Expression

*Hattie Martin
Justine Miles
Mary Jo (Chambers) Wedlow
Nikesha Madison
Elsie Cobb*

Minister Remarks

*Mark Sharpe, Southside Church of Christ
Stanley Winters Sr., Parkway Church of Christ
Mark Watkins Sr., Roseville Church of Christ
Dr. Sam Morris Sr., Bay North Church of Christ*

Solo

*"Two Wings"
Sam Morris Accompanied by Corey Williams*

Eulogy

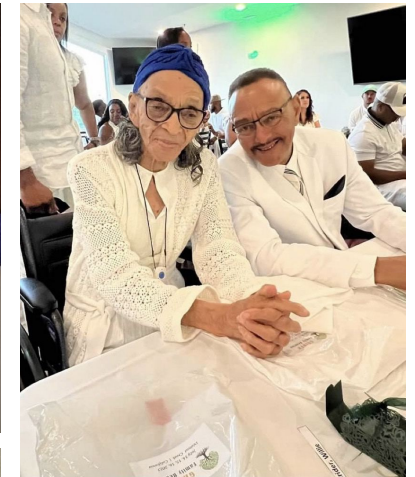
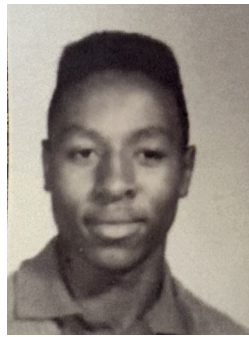
Dr. Lamont Francies Sr.

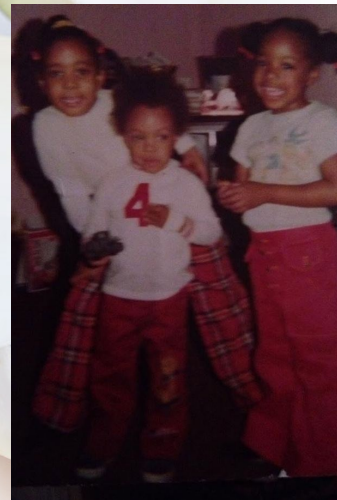
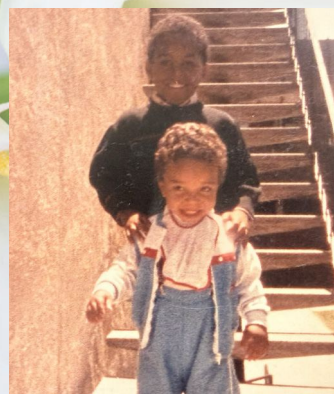
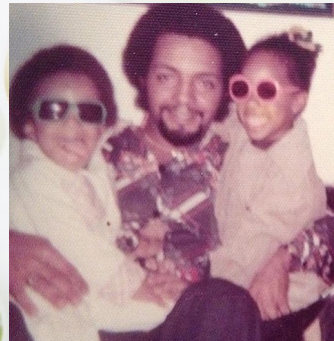
Parting View

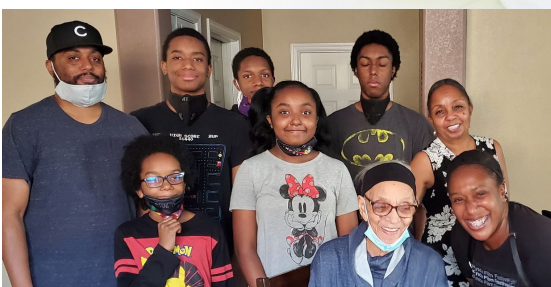
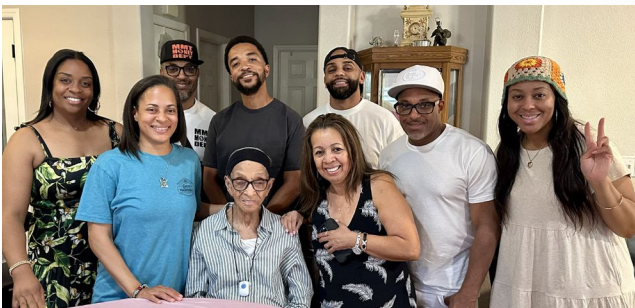
Rose Manor Mortuary











Memories

Waking up to the smell of coffee.
Looking over to see you sitting at the table
reading the newspaper.
Watching The Price Is Right at 10 AM
and Wheel of Fortune at 7:30 PM.
Getting in trouble for solving puzzles out loud
before you could figure them out.

Spreading corn around my plate to make it look
like I'd finished, only to have you scrape it all back
together then tell me: "Either eat it or go to bed."
So I went to bed.

Waking up alone in your bed,
realizing that y'all had snuck out to watch Arsenio Hall
because I was moving around too much.
Watching you take care of Granddaddy, day in and day out.
Riding in the car with you to the store,
and hearing you call a crazy driver a "big galoot".
Not ever knowing what a "galoot" was.

Watching you peep through the blinds,
or stand on a bucket to look over the patio wall
to see what was going on in Deliverance Temple.
Hearing you bang the broom on the ceiling
to tell the upstairs neighbors
they were making too much noise.

Cutting pink cookie dough into stars, trees, and ornaments.
Drawing Nike swooshes on gingerbread man feet
in frosting with a toothpick.
Crawling under your coffee table
when your apartment was full of family for holiday parties.
Playing dominoes with all of your trash-talking
grandchildren,
and you quietly schooling all of us.

Attending worship service at
Southside Church of Christ,
Hilltop Church of Christ,
Parkway Church of Christ,
Roseville Church of Christ,
and Kentucky Ave Church of Christ.

Telling you that I was expecting my first child,
and you telling me that you expected me to be
buying a ring.
Having you be the first person who could get my
son to take a bottle.
Sneaking you cake at my kids' birthday parties,
knowing you weren't supposed to have it.

Coaching basketball and seeing you on the sidelines,
taking it all in.
Coaching softball and seeing you in the stands,
taking it all in.
At plays, dance recitals and graduations,
taking it all in.

Hearing your stories about growing up with no electricity,
or watching your grandmother wring the necks of
chickens.
Hearing you tell me how much you love trees,
and never understood why Richmond didn't have any.

Wheeling you out of graduation early to avoid the crowds,
plotting with you on what we would do if anyone were
to get in our way.

Hearing you tell me how cold the dialysis room was,
and how impossible it was to rest in there.
Seeing you in your most uncomfortable moments,
struggling to find your breath, and still assuring us
that you were okay.

Seeing you finally at peace after all the suffering was over.

Watching you being prepared to go on your final ride.

Saying my final goodbye.

*Thank you, Grandmama, for 42 years of loving memories.
Rest well.*

Your Grandson,
Damon

Descendents of **Willie Lee Grider**

Ronnie Thompson • Marilyn Quilter • Sherron Grider • Joyce Grider • Terence Grider
Cynthia Fields • Auntione Grider • Sheree Turner • Gregory Warren Jr
Satina Grider-Dunigan • James Quilter Sr. • Nikesha Madison • John L. Hastings Jr.
Norman Quilter • Terence Hastings • Byron Quilter • Shareef Warren • Akilah Austin
Tiffany Francies • Ebony Quilter • Damon Hastings • Ronnie Thompson Jr. • Jamal Warren
Teyanna Ybarra • Auntionae Grider • Danae Gray • Gregory Warren III • Dakari Warren
Malik Quilter • Isinae Warren • Andre Alexander • Tia Mitchell • Twan-Che Grider
Lakeitha Quilter • Amani (Quilter) Hertzberg • Makayla Gordon • Dijon Turner
Auntione Grider Jr. • Jamari Warren • Ikikah Warren • Ajah Alexander • Tanea Quilter
Daniyah Turner • Tiare Warren • Ashanti Warren • Darrion Quilter • Tiffany Quilter
Byron Quilter Jr. • Maliyah Cayabyab • Terence Hastings Jr. • Justin Hastings • Erika Quilter
Dominic Austin • Devin Hastings • London Quilter • Jada Warren • Tamia Francies
Amiya Warren • Lhala Hastings • Brandon Madison • Giannie Thompson
Lamont Francies Jr • Tamar Quilter • Davion Quilter • Austin Hastings • Lauren Madison
James Quilter Jr. • Amar Hastings • Leilani Francies • Jalen Madison • Shalaya Warren
Vida Warren • Damani Austin • Brielle Gray • Malachi Francies • Malcolm Francies
Journey Gray • Zadyn Alexander • Indigo Quilter • Massaiah Quilter • Ma'laynah Gordon
Aleena Hastings • Shereece Warren • Gregory Warren IV • Xamonni Alexander
Tavion Quilter • Cara Moricelli • Melanie Quilter • Zyah Gray • Aujanah Warren • Mila Moss
Jayceon Quilter • Alina Turner • King Alexander • Aman Hastings • Nova Gray
Massaiah Gordon • Kash Warren • Amias Warren • Trinity McDaniel • Laila Quilter
Zariyah Quilter • Amali Warren • Gabrielle Mitchell • Alaya Turner • Jamari Warren Jr
Milani McDaniel • Zy'Air Quilter • Aurora Edwards • Lainey McDaniel
Ezekiel "Zeke" Hertzberg • Melody Mitchell

*I love Mama
Willie Lee Grider*

Pallbearers

Gregory Warren Jr.
Shareef Warren Sr.
Norman Quilter
Byron Quilter Sr.
Damon Hastings
Ronnie Thompson Jr.

Honorary Pallbearers

Terence Grider
James Eric Quilter Sr.
Terence Hastings Sr.
Jamal Warren

Family Acknowledgments

Perhaps you sent a lovely card or sat quietly in a chair; Perhaps you sent a floral spray, if so, we saw it there. Perhaps you spoke the kindest words as any friend could say; Perhaps you were not there at all, just thought of us that day. Whatever you did to console our hearts, we thank you so very much.

God opened a window of blessings and allowed us to realize the great love and support of our friends and Christian family. We truly thank you and may God bless you.

The family of Willie Lee Grider

Celebration of Life

September 26, 2026
Southside Church of Christ
1501 Florida Avenue

Interment

Rolling Hills Memorial Park
4100 Hilltop Dr

Repast

Moose Lodge
4660 Appian Way
El Sobrante CA 94803